



STUDENT GUIDE & WORKBOOK MODULE 2: TOPIC 1

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TOPIC 5

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

"In the last decade or so, science has discovered a tremendous amount about the role emotions play in our lives. Researchers have found that even more than IQ,

Your emotional awareness and abilities to handle feelings will determine your success and happiness in all walks of life, including family relationships."

-John Gottman

Learning Objectives:

- To understand what Emotional Intelligence (EI) is
- To define EI and its five elements
- To self-reflect on EI
- Complete the quiz and discuss answers
- Understand ways to Increase EI

Intro Question 1: What do you think Emotional Intelligence is?

Intro Question 2: What is more important – IQ or EI?

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE ARTICLE

Source: https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newCDV_59.htm

Emotional Intelligence

Developing Strong "People Skills"

We probably all know people, either at work or in our personal lives, who are good listeners. No matter what kind of situation we're in, they always seem to know just what to say – and how to say it – so that we're not offended or upset. They're caring and considerate, and even if we don't find a solution to our problem, we usually leave feeling more hopeful and optimistic.

We probably also know people who are masters at managing their emotions. They don't get angry in stressful situations. Instead, they have the ability to look at a problem and calmly find a solution. They're excellent decision makers, and they know when to trust their intuition. Regardless of their strengths, however, they're usually willing to look at themselves honestly. They take criticism well, and they know when to use it to improve their performance.

People like this have a high degree of emotional intelligence. They know themselves very well, and they're also able to sense the emotional needs of others.

Would you like to be more like this?

As more and more people accept that emotional intelligence is just as important to professional success as technical ability, organisations are increasingly using it when they hire and promote.

For example, one large cosmetic company recently revised their hiring process for salespeople to choose candidates based on their emotional intelligence. The result? People hired with the new system have sold, on average, \$91,000 more than salespeople selected under the old system. There has also been significantly lower staff turnover among the group chosen for their emotional intelligence.

So, what exactly is emotional intelligence, and what can you do to improve yours?

We all have different personalities, different wants and needs, and different ways of showing our emotions. Navigating through this all takes tact and cleverness – especially if we hope to succeed in life. This is where emotional intelligence becomes important.

Emotional intelligence is the ability to recognise your emotions, understand what they're telling you, and realise how your emotions affect people around you. It also



involves your perception of others: when you understand how they feel, this allows you to manage relationships more effectively.

People with high emotional intelligence are usually successful in most things they do. Why? Because they're the ones that others want on their team. When people with high emotional intelligence send an email, it gets answered. When they need help, they get it. Because they make others feel good, they go through life much more easily than people who are easily angered or upset.

CHARACTERISATIONS OF EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

In his book titled "Emotional Intelligence - Why It Can Matter More Than IQ" 1995, **Daniel Goleman, an American psychologist, developed a framework of five elements that define emotional intelligence:**

Self-Awareness – People with high emotional intelligence are usually very self-aware. They understand their emotions, and because of this, they don't let their feelings rule them. They're confident – because they trust their intuition and don't let their emotions get out of control. They're also willing to take an honest look at themselves. They know their strengths and weaknesses, and they work on these areas so they can perform better. Many people believe that this self-awareness is the most important part of emotional intelligence.

Self-Regulation – This is the ability to control emotions and impulses. People who self-regulate typically don't allow themselves to become too angry or jealous, and they don't make impulsive, careless decisions. They think before they act. Characteristics of self-regulation are thoughtfulness, comfort with change, integrity, and the ability to say no.

Motivation – People with a high degree of emotional intelligence are usually motivated. They're willing to defer immediate results for long-term success. They're highly productive, love a challenge, and are very effective in whatever they do.

Empathy – This is perhaps the second-most important element of emotional intelligence. Empathy is the ability to identify with and understand the wants, needs, and viewpoints of those around you. People with empathy are good at recognizing the feelings of others, even when those feelings may not be obvious. As a result, empathetic people are usually excellent at managing relationships, listening, and relating to others. They avoid stereotyping and judging too quickly, and they live their lives in a very open, honest way.

Social Skills – It's usually easy to talk to and like people with good social skills, another sign of high emotional intelligence. Those with strong social skills are typically team players. Rather than focus on their own success first, they help others develop and shine.

THE REFLECTIVE LEARNING PROCESS

I. Activity – Reflecting on the EI elements

Think about the EI Elements and Reflect on how well you think you perform in this element and what you can do to improve in this area.

Share your reflections with others (in a group of 2 or more) and ask them for advice on what you could do to improve in this element.

Example:

Element: Motivation – 5/10

I rated myself 5 out of 10 because I find it harder and harder to motivate myself to study and work. Sometimes I waste a lot of time playing computer games and/or on social media. I also go out with my friends and stay up late even when I know I should be studying PTE.

I think I can improve by writing down my goals every day and keep reminding myself that I need to sacrifice in short term to achieve my goals in the long run. First thing I can do is to delete face book and allow specific, limited time only so that I don't get distracted.

My classmates also suggested to find a study buddy or a group who can help me and keep me focused that way I will show up and study in the group, it's also extra motivation and helping each other.

My Rating:

Self-Awareness:	
Self- Regulation:	
Motivation:	
Empathy	
Social skills	

Suggestions on how I could improve on above Elements:

2. Activity – Reflecting on the EI elements

Identify a situation you encountered in your work or personal life that you believe could have been dealt with more effectively.

Describe the experience: What happened? When and where did the situation occur? Any other thoughts you have about the situation?

Reflection: How did you behave? What thoughts did you have? How did it make you feel? Were there other factors that influenced the situation? What have you learned from the experience?

Theorising: How did the experience match with your preconceived ideas (i.e. was the outcome expected or unexpected)? How does it relate to any formal theories that you know? What behaviours do you think might have changed the outcome?



Experimentation: Is there anything you could do or say now to change the outcome? What action(s) could you take to change similar reactions in the future?

What behaviours might you try out?

Read more at: <https://www.skillsyouneed.com/ps/reflective-practice.html>

3. Activity – Emotional Intelligence Quiz

Directions: The following 10 question quiz is designed to give you a general idea of how much you currently know about being emotionally intelligent.

Tick the answer which reflects what you would do in that situation. When you are finished, calculate how many times you selected each letter (e.g. **a** x3) and the trainer will go over the scoring process with you and help you interpret your results.

When it comes to Emotional Intelligence, how savvy are you?

- 1. You are on an airplane that suddenly hits extremely bad turbulence and begins rocking from side to side. What do you do?**
 - a) Continue to read your book or magazine, or watch the movie, trying to pay little attention to the turbulence
 - b) Become vigilant for an emergency, carefully monitoring the stewardesses and reading the emergency card instruction card
 - c) A little of both a and b
 - d) Not sure-never noticed

- 2. You are in a meeting when a colleague takes credit for work that you have done. What do you do?**
 - a) Immediately and publicly confront the colleague over the ownership of work
 - b) After the meeting, take the colleague aside and tell her that you would appreciate in the future that she credits you when speaking about your work
 - c) Nothing, it's not good idea to embarrass colleagues in public
 - d) After the colleague speaks, publicly thank her for referencing your work and give the group more specific detail about what you were trying to accomplish

- 3. You are a customer service representative and have just gotten an extremely angry client on the phone. What do you do?**
 - a) Hang-up. It doesn't pay to take abuse from anyone
 - b) Listen to the client and rephrase what you gather he is feeling
 - c) Explain to the client that he is being unfair, that you are only trying to do your job, and you would appreciate it if he wouldn't get in the way of this
 - d) Tell the client you understand how frustrating this must be for him and offer a specific thing you can do to help him get his problem resolved.

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- 4. You are a college student who had hoped to get an A in a course that was important for your future applications. You have just found out you got a C- on the midterm. What do you do?**
- a) Sketch out a specific plan for ways to improve your grade and resolve to follow through
 - b) Decide you do not have what it takes to make it in that career
 - c) Tell yourself that it really doesn't matter how much you do in the course, concentrate instead on other classes where your grades are higher
 - d) Go see the professor and try to talk her into giving you a better grade
- 5. You are a manager in the organisation that is trying to encourage respect for racial and ethnic diversity. You overhear someone telling a racist joke, what do you do?**
- a) Ignore it. The best way to deal with these things is not to react
 - b) Call the person into your office and explain that his behavior is inappropriate and is grounds for disciplinary action if repeated
 - c) Speak up on the spot, saying that such jokes are inappropriate and will not be tolerated in your organisation
 - d) Suggest to the person telling the joke to go through a diversity training program
- 6. You are an insurance salesman calling on prospective clients. You have left the last 15 clients empty-handed. What do you do?**
- a) Call it a day and go home early to miss rush hour traffic
 - b) Try something new in the next call, and keep plugging away
 - c) List your strengths and weaknesses to identify what may be undermining your ability to sell
 - d) Sharpen up your resume
- 7. You are trying to calm down a colleague who has worked herself into a fury because the driver of another car has cut dangerously close in front of her. What do you do?**
- a) Tell her to forget about it-she's OK now and it is no big deal
 - b) Put on one of her favourite tapes to try to distract her
 - c) Join her criticising the other driver
 - d) Tell her about a time something like this happened to you, and how angry you felt, until you saw the other driver was on the way to the hospital

8. A discussion between you and your partner has escalated into a shouting match, you are both upset and in the heat of the argument, start making personal attacks that neither of you really mean. What is the best thing to do?

- a) Agree to take a 20-minute break before continuing the discussion
- b) Go silent, regardless of what your partner says
- c) Say you are sorry, and ask your partner to apologise too
- d) Stop for the moment, collect your thoughts, then restate your side of the case as precisely as possible

9. You have been given the task of managing a team that has been unable to come up with a creative solution to a work problem. What is the first thing that you do?

- a) Draw up an agenda, call a meeting and allot a specific period of time to discuss each item
- b) Organise an off-site meeting aimed specifically at encouraging the team to get to know each other better
- c) Begin by asking each person individually for ideas about how to solve the problem
- d) Start out with a brainstorming session, encouraging each person to say whatever comes to mind, no matter how wild

10. You have recently been assigned a young manager in your team and have noticed that he appears to be unable to make the simplest of decisions without seeking advice from you. What do you do?

- a) Accept that he “does not have what it takes to succeed around here” and find others in your team to take on his tasks
- b) Get an HR manager to talk to him about where he sees his future in the organisation
- c) Purposely give him lots of complex decision to make so that he will become more confident in the role
- d) Engineer an ongoing series of challenging but manageable experienced foe him and make yourself available to act as his mentor.

My Emotional Intelligence Quiz score is: ____

The most interesting question/s is/are: ____

5 WAYS TO DEVELOP YOUR EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

Source: <https://www.forbes.com/sites/ashleystahl/2018/05/29/5-ways-to-develop-your-emotional-intelligence/#5a51f3496976>

1. Manage your negative emotions. When you're able to manage and reduce your negative emotions, you're less likely to get overwhelmed. Easier said than done, right? Try this: If someone is upsetting you, don't jump to conclusions. Instead, allow yourself to look at the situation in a variety of ways. Try to look at things objectively so you don't get riled up as easily. Practice mindfulness at work, and notice how your perspective changes.

2. Be mindful of your vocabulary. Focus on becoming a stronger communicator in the workplace. Emotionally intelligent people tend to use more specific words that can help communicate deficiencies, and then they immediately work to address them. Had a bad meeting with your boss? What made it so bad, and what can you do to fix it next time? When you can pinpoint what's going on, you have a higher likelihood of addressing the problem, instead of just stewing on it.

3. Practice empathy. Centring on verbal and non-verbal cues can give you invaluable insight into the feelings of your colleagues or clients. Practice focusing on others and walking in their shoes, even if just for a moment. Empathetic statements do not excuse unacceptable behaviour, but they help remind you that everyone has their own issues.

4. Know your stressors. Take stock of what stresses you out and be proactive to have less of it in your life. If you know that checking your work email before bed will send you into a tailspin, leave it for the morning. Better yet, leave it for when you arrive to the office.

5. Bounce back from adversity. Everyone encounters challenges. It's how you react to these challenges that either sets you up for success or puts you on the track to full on meltdown mode. You already know that positive thinking will take you far. To help you bounce back from adversity, practice optimism instead of complaining. What can you learn from this situation? Ask constructive questions to see what you can take away from the challenge at hand.

Emotional intelligence can evolve over time, if you have the desire to increase it. Every person, challenge, or situation faced is a prime learning opportunity to test your EQ. It takes practice, but you can start reaping the benefits immediately. Having a high level of emotional intelligence will serve you well in your relationships in the workplace and in all areas of your life. Who wouldn't want that?

SELF AWARENESS

If you're self-aware, you always know how you feel, and you know how your emotions and your actions can affect the people around you. Being self-aware when you're in a leadership position also means having a clear picture of your **strengths** and **weaknesses**, and it means behaving with **humility**.

So, what can you do to improve your self-awareness?

- **Keep a journal** – Journals help you improve your self-awareness. If you spend just a few minutes each day writing down your thoughts, this can move you to a higher degree of self-awareness
- **Slow down** – When you experience anger or other strong emotions, slow down to examine why. Remember, no matter what the situation, you can always choose how you react to it

SELF-REGULATION

Leaders who regulate themselves effectively rarely verbally attack others, make rushed or emotional decisions, stereotype people, or compromise their values. Self-regulation is all about staying in control. This element of emotional intelligence, according to Goleman, also covers a leader's flexibility and commitment to **personal accountability**. *So, how can you improve your ability to self-regulate?*

Know your values – Do you have a clear idea of where you absolutely will not compromise? Do you know what values are most important to you? Spend some time examining your "code of ethics." If you know what's most important to you, then you probably won't have to think twice when you face a moral or ethical decision – you'll make the right choice.

Hold yourself accountable – If you tend to blame others when something goes wrong, stop. Make a commitment to admit to your mistakes and to face the consequences, whatever they are. You'll probably sleep better at night, and you'll quickly earn the respect of those around you.

Practice being calm – The next time you're in a challenging situation, be very aware of how you act. Do you relieve your stress by shouting at someone else? Practise deep-breathing exercises to calm yourself. Also, try to write down all the negative things you want to say, and then rip it up and throw it away. Expressing these emotions on paper (and not showing them to anyone!) is better than speaking them aloud to your team. What's more, this helps you challenge your reactions to ensure that they're fair!

MOTIVATION

Self-motivated leaders work consistently toward their goals, and they have extremely high standards for the quality of their work.

How can you improve your motivation?

- **Re-examine why you're doing your job** – It's easy to forget what you really love about your career. So, take some time to remember why you wanted this job. If you're unhappy in your role and you're struggling to remember why you wanted it, try the **Five Whys Technique** to find the root of the problem. Starting at the root often helps you look at your situation in a new way – and make sure that your goal statements are fresh and energising
- **Know where you stand** – Determine how motivated you are to lead role. If you need to increase your motivation to lead, it directs you to resources that can help
- **Be hopeful and find something good** – Motivated leaders are usually optimistic, no matter what problems they face. Adopting this mindset might take practice, but it's well worth the effort

Every time you face a challenge, or even a failure, try to find at least one good thing about the situation. It might be something small, like a new contact, or something with long-term effects, like an important lesson learned. But there's almost always something positive, if you look for it.

EMPATHY

For leaders, having empathy is critical to managing a successful team or organisation. Leaders with empathy have the ability to put themselves in someone else's situation. They help develop the people on their team, challenge others who are acting unfairly, give constructive feedback, and listen to those who need it.

If you want to earn the respect and loyalty of your team, then show them you care by being empathic.

How can you improve your empathy?

- **Put yourself in someone else's position** – It's easy to support your own point of view. After all, it's yours! But take the time to look at situations from other people's perspectives. See our article on Perceptual Positions for a useful technique for doing this
- **Pay attention to body language** – Perhaps when you listen to someone, you cross your arms, move your feet back and forth, or bite your lip. This body language tells others how you really feel about a situation, and the message



you're giving isn't positive! Learning to read body language can be a real asset in a leadership role, because you'll be better able to determine how someone truly feels. This gives you the opportunity to respond appropriately

- **Respond to feelings** – You ask your assistant to work late – again. And although he agrees, you can hear the disappointment in his voice. So, respond by addressing his feelings. Tell him you appreciate how willing he is to work extra hours, and that you're just as frustrated about working late. If possible, figure out a way for future late nights to be less of an issue (for example, give him Monday mornings off)

SOCIAL SKILLS

Leaders who do well in the social skills element of emotional intelligence are great communicators. They're just as open to hearing bad news as good news, and they're expert at getting their team to support them and be excited about a new mission or project.

Leaders who have good social skills are also good at managing change and resolving conflicts diplomatically. They're rarely satisfied with leaving things as they are, but they don't sit back and make everyone else do the work: they set an example with their own behaviour.

So, how can you build social skills?

- **Learn conflict resolution** – Leaders must know how to resolve conflicts between their team members, customers, or vendors. Learning **conflict resolution** skills are vital if you want to succeed
- **Improve your communication skills** – How well do you communicate?
- **Learn how to praise others** – As a leader, you can inspire the loyalty of your team simply by giving praise when it's earned. Learning how to praise others is a fine art, but well worth the effort

Source: https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newLDR_45.htm

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